

UK Megadeals: Past, Present and Future

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Chapter 1: Investment trends

Top investors

Venture capital firm Accel tops the list of investors involved in UK megadeals over the last decade. The Paulo Alto based heavyweight has backed several high-profile companies in deals of £50m or more including Deliveroo, Monzo, Lyl and Inspira.

Accel is closely followed by Woodford Investment Management and DST Global with 14 deals each.

While the Financial Conduct Authority is still finalising its report into the failure of Woodford's Equity Income fund, the data shows the role the investor played in backing the UK's IP-backed growth companies.

Russian-based DST Global was set up in 2009 as an investment vehicle for Mikhail Fridman. Now an independent entity, it has participated in megadeals

with Farfetch, Funding Circle, and Bulb.

Turning to the first half of 2021, BlackRock makes a striking appearance at the top of the list with five megadeals. Over the 10 years prior the US firm had only participated in five other UK megadeals. The first half of 2021 is an aggressive ramping up of investments into large private companies in the UK.

Top investors by number of megadeals participated in (2011 - H1 2021)

Accel	25
Woodford Investment Management	14
Digital Sky Technologies (2017 Global)	14
Tenavak	11
Insight Partners	11
General Catalyst Partners	11
BlackRock	10
DeBank Vision Fund	8
Cable Management	8
Tiger Global Management	7
Index Ventures	7
Bulfinch Clifford	7
Synovus Partners	6
Google Ventures	6
Draper Esprit	6
Redstone Capital	6
Perception Advisors	5
Perscion Capital	5
IP Group	5
Cambridge Innovation Capital (CIC)	5

Top investors by number of megadeals participated in (H1 2021)

BlackRock	5
Tiger Global Management	4
Softbank Vision Fund	4
LightSpeed Venture Partners	4
General Catalyst Partners	4
Edgewise Industries	4
Tencent	3
Tenavak	3
Target Global	3
Latitude Ventures	3
Insight Partners	3
Google Ventures	3
Draper Esprit	3
Digital Sky Technologies	3
Cambridge Innovation Capital	2
Bulfinch Clifford	2
Addison	2
Access Industries	2
Accel	2

Investors have been counted based on the number deals they have participated in. This means that one deal may be counted several times depending on how many investors participated.

9

Chapter 2: Where's the money going?

Map of companies that have raised megadeals

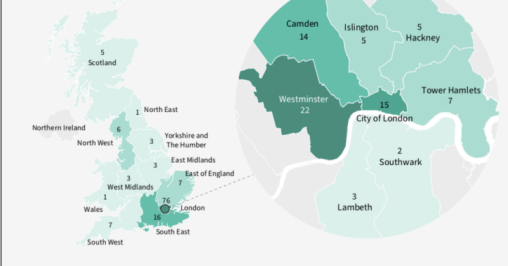
Unsurprisingly, London is home to the vast majority of active companies that have raised megadeals, currently hosting 76 companies that have raised £50m or more over the last 10 and half years. The access to finance, talent and customers in the capital makes it a natural location for the sort of growth company that has such extreme capital needs. The local authority of Westminster is home to 22 active companies, reflecting the significant overall population of high-growth and equity-backed companies in the borough. Westminster is followed by the City with 15 companies and Camden with 14.

Outside of London, the south of the country is still home to high numbers of active companies that have raised megadeals. Sixteen active companies based in the South East have raised megadeals since 2011, while the East of England hosts 7 companies.

Location of companies that have raised megadeals by region and local authority area (2011 - H1 2021)

Companies that have raised a megadeal by region
1 75+
2 50-74
3 25-49
4 10-24
5 1-9

Companies that have raised a megadeal by London Local Authority Area
1 20+
2 10-19
3 5-9
4 1-4



11

About the authors



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Henry leads Beauhurst's research and consultancy, and is an expert on equity finance and high-growth business. He has worked on briefs for clients including Barclays, Syndicate Room, Innovate UK, Smith & Williamson and the British Business Bank. Henry regularly gives presentations on finance and market trends at events around the country. Henry studied Classics at the University of Oxford.



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Daniel conducts data manipulation, visualisation and analysis as part of the Research and Consultancy team. He has a background in business analysis and commercial copywriting in Australia and the United Kingdom. He previously worked at The Sunday Times Fast Track, Oxford University Press, and advertising network MullenLowe Group.



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